

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250285677

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

CHIH; Yu-Der et al.

RESISTIVE RANDOM ACCESS MEMORY DEVICE

Abstract

A method includes causing a first information bit to be written into a first bit cell in a first plurality of bit cells as an original logic state of the first information bit. The method also includes causing a second information bit to be written into a second bit cell in a second plurality of bit cells as an original logic state of the second information bit. The method also includes causing a third information bit to be written into a third bit cell in a third plurality of bit cells as a logically complementary state of the first information bit.

Inventors: CHIH; Yu-Der (Hsinchu, TW), CHOU; Chung-Cheng (Hsinchuy, TW), CHU; Wen-Ting (Hsinchu, TW)

Applicant: TAIWAN SEMICONDUCTOR MANUFACTURING COMPANY, LTD.
(Hsinchu, TW)

Family ID: 1000008618368

Appl. No.: 19/214446

Filed: May 21, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 18417729 20240119 parent-grant-document US 12322441 child US 19214446

parent US continuation 18080696 20221213 parent-grant-document US 11915754 child US 18417729

parent US continuation 17330248 20210525 parent-grant-document US 11557344 child US 18080696

parent US continuation 17003761 20200826 parent-grant-document US 11024381 child US 17330248

parent US continuation 16158498 20181012 parent-grant-document US 10762960 child US

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G11C13/00** (20060101); **H10B63/00** (20230101); **H10N70/00** (20230101); **H10N70/20** (20230101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G11C13/0069** (20130101); **G11C13/0026** (20130101); **G11C13/0028** (20130101); **G11C13/003** (20130101); **G11C13/004** (20130101); **H10B63/30** (20230201); **H10B63/80** (20230201); **H10B63/84** (20230201); **H10N70/253** (20230201); **H10N70/841** (20230201); G11C13/0007 (20130101); G11C2013/0045 (20130101); G11C2013/0054 (20130101); G11C2013/0078 (20130101); G11C2213/79 (20130101); H10N70/20 (20230201); H10N70/826 (20230201); H10N70/8833 (20230201)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/417,729, filed Jan. 19, 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/080,696, filed Dec. 13, 2022, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,915,754, issued Feb. 27, 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/330,248, filed May 25, 2021, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,557,344, issued Jan. 17, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/003,761, filed on Aug. 26, 2020, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,024,381, issued Jun. 1, 2021, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/158,498, filed on Oct. 12, 2018, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,762,960, issued Sep. 1, 2020, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/592,574, filed on Nov. 30, 2017, each of which is incorporated by reference herein in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Integrated circuits that serve as memory devices or include memory portions are very popular and serve a variety of functions in the electronics world. Resistive random-access memory (RRAM) devices are non-volatile memory type devices formed using semiconductor manufacturing methods. The RRAM device bears some similarities to conductive-bridging RAM (CBRAM) and phase change memory devices.

[0003] Generally, RRAM devices operate under the principle that a dielectric, which is normally insulating, can be made to conduct through a filament or conduction path formed after the application of a sufficiently high voltage. The conduction path formation can arise from different mechanisms, including but not limited to defect, metal migration, oxygen vacancy, etc. Various different dielectric materials may be used in RRAM devices. Once the filament or conduction path is formed, it may be reset, i.e. broken, resulting in a high resistance state (HRS) or set, i.e. re-formed, resulting in a lower resistance (LRS), by an appropriately applied voltage, respectively.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0004] Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It is noted that various features are not

necessarily drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

[0005] FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary block diagram of a resistive random access memory (RRAM) architecture, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0006] FIG. 2 illustrates an exemplary block diagram of an RRAM macro of the RRAM architecture of FIG. 1 in accordance with some embodiments.

[0007] FIG. 3 illustrates an exemplary schematic diagram of an RRAM cell of one of the RRAM cell arrays of the RRAM macro 108 of FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0008] FIG. 4 illustrates an exemplary schematic diagram of the RRAM architecture of FIG. 1, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0009] FIG. 5A illustrates an exemplary schematic diagram of a word line (WL) signal source circuit of the RRAM architecture of FIG. 1, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0010] FIG. 5B illustrates an exemplary schematic diagram of a bit line (BL) signal source circuit of the RRAM architecture of FIG. 1, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0011] FIG. 5C illustrates an exemplary schematic diagram of a sense amplifier and a portion of an input/output (I/O) circuit of the RRAM architecture of FIG. 1, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0012] FIG. 5D illustrates exemplary operation comparisons between two types of sensing amplifier circuits, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0013] FIG. 6 illustrates a flow chart of an exemplary method to operate the RRAM architecture of FIG. 1, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0014] FIG. 7 illustrates a flow chart of an exemplary method to fabricate the RRAM macro of FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

[0015] The following disclosure describes various exemplary embodiments for implementing different features of the subject matter. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. Additionally, it will be understood that when an element is referred to as being “connected to” or “coupled to” another element, it may be directly connected to or coupled to the other element, or one or more intervening elements may be present.

[0016] In recent years, unconventional nonvolatile memory (NVM) devices, such as ferroelectric random access memory (FRAM) devices, magnetic random access memory (MRAM) devices, phase-change random access memory (PRAM) devices, and resistive random access memory (RRAM) devices, have emerged. In particular, RRAM devices, which exhibit a switching behavior between a high resistance state and a low resistance state, have various advantages over conventional NVM devices. Such advantages include, for example, compatible fabrication steps with current complementary-metal-oxide-semiconductor (CMOS) technologies, low-cost fabrication, a compact structure, flexible scalability, fast switching, high integration density, etc.

[0017] In general, an RRAM device, or more particularly an RRAM cell, includes an upper (anode) electrode and a lower (cathode) electrode with a variable resistance dielectric layer interposed between the upper and lower electrodes. In some examples, an RRAM cell may further include a capping layer interposed between the upper electrode and the variable resistance dielectric layer thereby causing the RRAM cell to have a bipolar switching behavior. The term “bipolar” as used herein refers to the two voltage polarities of an RRAM cell that exhibits a first conductive behavior with a first polarity of voltage applied across the upper and lower electrodes, and a second conductive behavior with a second polarity (a polarity opposite to the first polarity) of voltage

applied across the upper and lower electrodes.

[0018] As described above, during a write operation to the RRAM cell, a 'set' voltage is applied across the upper and lower electrodes to change the variable resistance dielectric layer from a first resistivity (e.g., a high resistance state (HRS)) to a second resistivity (e.g., a low resistance state (LRS)). Similarly, a 'reset' voltage is applied across the upper and lower electrodes to change the variable resistance dielectric layer from the second resistivity back to the first resistivity, for example, from LRS to HRS. Therefore, in instances where the LRS and HRS correspond to logic "1" and logic "0" states (or vice versa), respectively, the 'set' and 'reset' voltages can be used to store digital information bits in the RRAM cell.

[0019] Various figures-of-merit are used to assess performance of an RRAM cell. In particular, among the various figures-of-merit, endurance of an RRAM cell is generally used to assess for which application the RRAM cell is suitable. Endurance of an RRAM cell is referred to the number of cycles (from HRS to LRS, or vice versa) the RRAM cell can endure before the

[0020] HRS and LRS of the RRAM cell become indistinguishable. Depending on the type of application in which an RRAM cell will be used, an RRAM cell with a particular endurance level or range may be selected for a certain application. For example, when an RRAM cell is used for an electrical fuse (eFuse), the endurance of the eFuse RRAM cell is typically less than about 10 cycles. In another example, when an RRAM cell is used as a multi-time programmable (MTP) memory device, the endurance of the MTP RRAM device is typically between about 10 and 1,000 cycles. Yet in another example, when an RRAM cell is used to store data (e.g., a flash memory device), the endurance of such an RRAM cell is typically between about 10,000 and 100,000 cycles. The figures-of-merit (e.g., endurance, retention time, etc.) of an RRAM cell may be determined by selecting a particular thickness and/or crystalline structure of the variable resistance dielectric layer in the RRAM cell, as described in further detail below.

[0021] In order to fabricate an RRAM device having plural RRAM cells on a single chip/die that can be used in multiple applications that each requires a respective different endurance, conventionally, multiple recipes to form multiple variable resistance dielectric layers, each with different thickness and/or crystalline structure, are typically used. As such, extra amounts of time/cost/fabrication steps may be used to produce an RRAM device that can be used in two or more applications. Thus, the conventional RRAM devices have not been entirely satisfactory in every aspect.

[0022] Embodiments of the present disclosure provide a novel RRAM architecture that includes a plurality of RRAM cell arrays integrated as an RRAM macro, wherein each RRAM cell array includes a plurality of RRAM cells. In some embodiments, at least a pair of the plurality of RRAM cell arrays are configured to present one information bit as two complementary logic states at respective RRAM cells through write operations. That is, an RRAM cell of one of the pair of RRAM cell arrays is configured to present an information bit as its original logic state; and an RRAM cell of the other of the pair of RRAM cell array pairs is configured to present the information bit as its complementary logic state. As such, when compared to conventional RRAM devices that rely on a fixed reference current signal to read out respective logic states, the pair of RRAM cell arrays of the disclosed RRAM architecture can present a greater difference between respective read current signals while being read out, which in turn can lower magnitudes of write voltage signals (e.g., the set/reset voltages as mentioned above). Thus, such a pair of RRAM cell arrays may be used in applications that require higher endurance.

[0023] Further, in some embodiments, the RRAM macro may include at least one RRAM cell array, different from the pair of RRAM cell arrays, that is configured to present information bits in their respective logic states. Such an RRAM cell array may be used in applications that require lower endurance, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, each RRAM cell array of the RRAM macro uses an universal variable resistance dielectric layer with a particular thickness and/or crystalline structure, formed by using a single same recipe, in its respective

RRAM cells. Thus, even when only a single recipe is used to form the respective variable resistance dielectric layers, the disclosed RRAM architecture can incorporate multiple RRAM cell arrays suitable for multiple applications (e.g., eFuse, MTP, data storage, etc.) on a single chip by using the single recipe without the requirements of extra amounts of time/cost/fabrication steps, as seen in conventional RRAM devices. This is because different RRAM cell arrays on the single chip can have different memory elements, e.g. the variable resistance dielectric layers, in terms of different diameters to satisfy different operating endurances.

[0024] FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary block diagram of a disclosed RRAM architecture **100** in accordance with various embodiments. As shown, the RRAM architecture **100** is formed on a single chip/die **102**, and the RRAM architecture **100** includes a control logic circuit **104**, a signal source circuit **106** coupled to the control logic circuit **104**, and at least one RRAM macro **108** coupled to the control logic circuit **104** and the signal source circuit **106**, respectively. While any number of RRAM macros may be integrated into the RRAM architecture **100** and remain within the scope of the present disclosure, for clarity of discussion, one RRAM macro (e.g., **108**) is shown in the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 1.

[0025] In some embodiments, the RRAM macro **108** includes a plurality of RRAM cell arrays, each of which includes a plurality of RRAM cells, which will be discussed with reference to FIGS. 2 and 3. In some embodiments, the control logic circuit **104** is configured to cause at least a pair of the plurality of RRAM cell arrays to present a single information bit as its original and complementary logic states so as to suit such a pair of RRAM cell arrays for higher-endurance applications; and cause at least another one of the plurality of RRAM cell arrays to present a single information bit at its original logic state so as to suit such an RRAM cell array for lower-endurance applications. In some embodiments, the signal source circuit **106**, which may be provided by a voltage converter (e.g., a charge pump), is configured to provide one or more voltage signals to the RRAM cells of the RRAM macro **108** for respective read/write operations. Details of the signal source circuit **106** will be discussed with reference to FIGS. 5A and 5B.

[0026] FIG. 2 illustrates a top view of an exemplary block diagram of the RRAM macro **108** of the RRAM architecture **100** of FIG. 1, in accordance with some embodiments. Other RRAM macros of the RRAM architecture **100** not shown in FIG. 1 may be each substantially similar to the illustrated embodiment of RRAM macro **108** of FIG. 2. As shown in FIG. 2, the RRAM macro **108** includes RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206**, word line (WL) drivers **208**, **210**, and **212**, a top sink **214**, a bottom sink **216**, and an input/output (I/O) circuit **218**. Although the RRAM macro **108** includes three RRAM cell arrays in the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 2, it is understood that the RRAM macro **108** may include any plurality number of RRAM cell arrays while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure.

[0027] In some embodiments, each RRAM cell array of the RRAM macro **108** is coupled with a respective WL driver. For example, the RRAM cell array **202** is coupled with the WL driver **208**; the RRAM cell array **204** is coupled with the WL driver **210**; and the RRAM cell array **206** is coupled with the WL driver **212**. On the other hand, the top and bottom sinks **214/216**, and the I/O circuit **218** (which includes sensing amplifier(s), multiplexers(s), bit line (BL) driver(s), etc., as will be discussed below) may be shared by the RRAM cell arrays **202-206**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. Alternatively stated, the top and bottom sinks **214/216** and I/O circuit **218** may be globally used by the top and bottom sinks **214/216** and I/O circuit **218** while operating the RRAM macro **108**.

[0028] In some embodiments, the RRAM cell array **202** has a different memory element size or diameter from those of the RRAM cell arrays **204**, **206**. For example, each cell in the RRAM cell array **202** may have a smaller diameter, which means a higher operating voltage level and a lower endurance, compared to a cell in the RRAM cell arrays **204**, **206**. This may be applied when all RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, **206** are same type of circuits (e.g. all 1c1b circuits by utilizing one cell to represent one bit). For different cells to achieve different diameters but same thickness and

crystalline structure, a same recipe may be used to fabricate the cells by controlling the layout sizes of the cells. For example, an RRAM cell array **202** having an endurance of e.g. 1 to 10 cycles and RRAM cell arrays **204**, **206** having an endurance of e.g. 10,000 and 100,000 cycles can be manufactured in one RRAM macro using a same recipe.

[0029] FIG. **3** illustrates an exemplary schematic diagram of an RRAM cell **300** of one of the RRAM cell arrays **202/204/206** of the RRAM macro **108** of FIG. **2**, in accordance with some embodiments. In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **3**, the exemplary RRAM cell **300** includes a resistor **302** and a transistor **304** coupled to the resistor **302** in series, which can utilized to provide respective resistor and transistor of each of other RRAM cells of the RRAM cell arrays **202/204/206**, respectively. Such an RRAM cell **300** is typically referred to as a 1-transistor-1-resistor (1T1R) configuration. Although, in FIG. **3**, the RRAM cells (e.g., **300**) of the RRAM cell arrays **202/204/206** are implemented as the 1T1R configuration, any of a variety of structures that exhibits a characteristic of variable resistance may be used by the RRAM cells of the RRAM cell arrays **202/204/206** such as, for example, a 1-diode-1-resistor (1D1R) configuration, a 1-selector-1-resistor (1S1R) configuration, a 1-transistor-many resistors (1T-manyR) configuration, etc., while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure.

[0030] As shown in FIG. **3**, the resistor **302** is formed as a multi-layer stack that includes a top electrode **312**, a capping layer **322**, a variable resistance dielectric layer **332**, and a bottom electrode **342**. In some embodiments, the top electrode **312** may be formed from at least one of the materials selected from: Pt, TiN/Ti, TiN, Ru, Ni, and combinations thereof; the capping layer **322** may be formed from at least one of the transition metal materials such as, Ti, Ni, Hf, Nb, Co, Fe, Cu, V, Ta, W, Cr, and combinations thereof; the variable resistance dielectric layer **332** may be formed from at least one of the transition metal oxide materials such as, TiO.sub.x, NiO.sub.x, HfO.sub.x, NbO.sub.x, CoO.sub.x, FeO.sub.x, CuO.sub.x, VO.sub.x, TaO.sub.x, WO.sub.x, CrO.sub.x, and combinations thereof; and the bottom electrode **342** may be formed of at least one of the materials selected from: TiN, TaN, W, Pt, and combinations thereof. In some embodiments, the variable resistance dielectric layer **332** may include a high-k dielectric layer.

[0031] To operate (e.g., write a logic state to) the RRAM cell **300** formed as the 1T1R configuration, generally, the transistor **304** is first activated (i.e., turned on) by an enabling/selecting signal through a word line (WL) connected to a gate of the transistor **304**, and then a voltage signal (e.g., a set voltage, or a reset voltage) is applied across the RRAM cell **300** through a bit line (BL) and a source line (SL) connected to the top electrode **312** of the resistor **302** and a source of the transistor **304**, respectively. For example, to write a logic **1** to the RRAM cell **300**, a set voltage is applied across the RRAM cell **300** (e.g., the BL is applied with the set voltage while the SL is connected to ground, or the SL is applied with the set voltage while the BL is connected to ground) to cause the variable resistance dielectric layer **332** to switch to the LRS (low resistance state); and to write a logic **0** to the RRAM cell **300**, a reset voltage, with a lower magnitude than the set voltage, is applied across the RRAM cell **300** (e.g., the BL is applied with the reset voltage while the SL is connected to ground, or the SL is applied with the reset voltage while the BL is connected to ground) to cause the variable resistance dielectric layer **332** to switch to the HRS (high resistance state). Similarly, to read out the written logic state from the RRAM cell **300**, after the transistor **304** is activated, a read voltage, typically with a lower magnitude than the magnitudes of the set and reset voltages, is applied across the RRAM cell **300**, and based on a magnitude of a current signal (which varies because of the resistance state of the variable resistance dielectric layer **332**) conducting through the RRAM cell, the logic state written into the RRAM cell **300** can be determined.

[0032] In some embodiments, respective polarities of the set and reset voltages to write an RRAM cell are not necessarily to be the same. Specifically, when the polarities are the same (e.g., both positive, or both negative), the RRAM cell is typically referred to as a unipolar RRAM cell; and when the polarities are different from each other (e.g., one is positive and the other is negative), the

RRAM cell is typically referred to as a bipolar RRAM cell. In accordance with some embodiments, each RRAM cell of the RRAM cell arrays **202/204/206** of the RRAM macro **108** can be either a bipolar or a unipolar RRAM cell.

[0033] In general, the variable resistance dielectric layer (e.g., a transition metal oxide layer) **332** is formed by deposition, for example, atomic layer deposition (ALD), chemical vapor deposition (CVD), meta-organic chemical vapor deposition (MOCVD), etc., to have a particular thickness and crystalline structure using a particular recipe. A recipe may include a variety of control parameters to control the deposition equipment, for example, gas flow rate, chamber pressure, partial pressure of a gas line, temperature, etc. To form a variable resistance dielectric layer with a particular thickness and crystalline structure, a particular value for each of the variety of control parameters may be selected. In some embodiments, the RRAM cells of the RRAM cell arrays **202/204/206** of the RRAM macro **108** are each formed by a single recipe.

[0034] FIG. **4** illustrates an exemplary circuit schematic diagram **400** of the RRAM architecture **100** of FIG. **1**, in accordance with some embodiments. Although in the exemplary circuit schematic diagram **400** of FIG. **4**, the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** each includes one RRAM cell, it is understood that, in some embodiments, the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** each includes a plurality of RRAM cells arranged in a column-row configuration, wherein each row includes a respective WL and each column includes respective BL and SL and each of the plurality of RRAM cells is arranged at a respective intersection of column (BL/SL) and row (WL).

[0035] For example, the RRAM cell **402** of the plurality of RRAM cells of the RRAM cell array **202** is arranged at an intersection of a first row of plural rows (e.g., a row including WL **410**) and a first column of plural columns (e.g., a column including BL **408-1** and SL **412-1**) of the RRAM cell array **202**; the RRAM cell **404** of the plurality of RRAM cells of the RRAM cell array **204** is arranged at an intersection of a first row of plural rows (e.g., a row including WL **414**) and a first column of plural columns (e.g., a column including BL **408-2** and SL **412-2**) of the RRAM cell array **204**; and the RRAM cell **406** of the plurality of RRAM cells of the RRAM cell array **206** is arranged at an intersection of a first row of plural rows (e.g., a row including WL **416**) and a first column of plural columns (e.g., a column including BL **408-3** and SL **412-3**) of the RRAM cell array **206**.

[0036] Further, in some embodiments, the RRAM cells of the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204** and **206** may be each implemented as an 1T1R RRAM cell formed by a resistor and a transistor that are coupled in series (FIG. **3**). Such an 1T1R RRAM cell is formed as a three terminal device, wherein the three terminals are respectively coupled to corresponding BL, WL, and SL.

[0037] As illustrated in the example of FIG. **4**, the RRAM cell array **202** includes an RRAM cell **402** formed by a resistor **402R** and a transistor **402T** that are coupled in series; the RRAM cell array **204** includes an RRAM cell **404** formed by a resistor **404R** and a transistor **404T** that are coupled in series; and the RRAM cell array **206** includes an RRAM cell **406** formed by a resistor **406R** and a transistor **406T** that are coupled in series. Further, the RRAM cell **402** is coupled to the BL **408-1** (through an end of the resistor **402R** not connected to the transistor **402T**), WL **410** (through a gate of the transistor **402T**), and SL **412-1** (through a source of the transistor **402T**); the RRAM cell **404** is coupled to the BL **408-2** (through an end of the resistor **404R** not connected to the transistor **404T**), WL **414** (through a gate of the transistor **404T**), and SL **412-2** (through a source of the transistor **404T**); and the RRAM cell **406** is coupled to the BL **408-3** (through an end of the resistor **406R** not connected to the transistor **406T**), WL **416** (through a gate of the transistor **406T**), and SL **412-3** (through a source of the transistor **406T**).

[0038] It is understood that in some embodiments, the BL **408-1** of the RRAM cell array **202** may be coupled to the BL **408-2** of the RRAM cell array **204**, but isolated from the BL **408-3** of the RRAM cell array **206** for the purposes of avoiding cross-talk of signals when two RRAM cells on the sides of the I/O circuit **218** (e.g., RRAM cells **404** and **046**) are concurrently accessed.

Similarly, the SL **412-1** of the RRAM cell array **202** may be coupled to the SL **412-2** of the RRAM

cell array **204**, but isolated from the SL **412-3** of the RRAM cell array **206** for the same purposes. [0039] In some embodiments, the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** are each coupled to the signal source circuit **106** through the respective WL drivers **208/210/212**, as mentioned above. More specifically, the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** are coupled to a WL signal source circuit **106W** of the signal source circuit **106** through respective WL drivers **208**, **210**, and **212** via corresponding WL's **410**, **414**, and **416**. In some embodiments, each of the WL drivers **208/210/212** includes a pull-up transistor (e.g., a p-type MOSFET) and a pull-down transistor (e.g., an n-type MOSFET) that are coupled to each other in series. It is understood that the pull-up and pull-down transistors may be each implemented as any of various other types of transistors while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure.

[0040] For example, the WL driver **208** includes a pull-up transistor **418U** and a pull-down transistor **418D**; the WL driver **210** includes a pull-up transistor **420U** and a pull-down transistor **420D**; and the WL driver **212** includes a pull-up transistor **422U** and a pull-down transistor **422D**. Both of the pull-up and pull-down transistors in each of the WL drivers **208**, **210**, and **212** are coupled to the control logic circuit **104** at their respective gates and controlled by the control logic circuit **104** to be selectively turned on/off, and the pull-up transistors in each of the WL drivers **208**, **210**, and **212** are coupled to the WL signal source circuit **106W** at their respective sources to receive a WL voltage signal **423**, as will be discussed below. Details of the WL signal source circuit **106W** will be discussed with reference to FIG. 5A.

[0041] In some embodiments, the top and bottom sinks **214** and **216** may respectively include one or more transistors (**426**, **428**, and **430**) and (**432**, **434**, and **436**) that are each controlled by the control logic circuit **104** to be selectively turned on/off. The transistors **426**, **428**, **430**, **432**, **434**, and **436** may be each implemented as an n-type MOSFET, or any of various other types of transistors while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the I/O circuit **218** may include transistors **438**, **440**, **442**, **444**, **446**, and **448**, a plurality of transmission gates **450**, **452**, **454**, and **456**, and a sensing amplifier (SA) **458**.

[0042] In some embodiments, the I/O circuit **218** is selectively coupled to the RRAM cell of one or more of the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** via corresponding BL's and SL's. In particular, to be accessed (e.g., either written or read), the RRAM cell **402** of the RRAM cell array **202** is selected, by the control logic circuit **104**, to be coupled by the I/O circuit **218** through activating the transmission gates **450** and **452**; the RRAM cell **404** of the RRAM cell array **204** is selected, by the control logic circuit **104**, to be coupled by the I/O circuit **218** through activating the transmission gates **450** and **452**; and the RRAM cell **406** of the RRAM cell array **206** is selected, by the control logic circuit **104**, to be coupled by the I/O circuit **218** through activating the transmission gates **454** and **456**.

[0043] In some embodiments, while being written (i.e., corresponding transmission gates have been activated), each RRAM cell of the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** is configured to receive a BL voltage signal (e.g., a set voltage, or a reset voltage) **453** from a BL signal source circuit **106B** of the signal source circuit through the I/O circuit **218** and then through a corresponding BL or SL. More specifically, the transistors **442**, **444**, **446**, and **448** may be controlled, by the control logic circuit **104**, to be selectively turned on/off so as to allow the BL voltage signal **453** to be delivered to a desired RRAM cell through a desired BL or SL. The transistors **442**, **444**, **446**, and **448** may be each implemented as an n-type MOSFET, or any of various other types of transistors while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure.

[0044] In some embodiments, while being read (i.e., corresponding transmission gates have been activated), the SA **458** is coupled to the RRAM cell of one of the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** through the transistors **438** and **440** that are selectively turned on/off by the control logic circuit **104**, or the respective RRAM cells of two RRAM cell arrays disposed on opposite sides of the I/O circuit **218** also through the selective on/off transistors **438** and **440**. The transistors **438** and **440** that function as passing gates may be each implemented as an n-type MOSFET, or any of

various other types of transistors while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure. Details of the BL signal source circuit **106B** and the SA **458** will be discussed with reference to FIG. 5B and FIG. 5C, respectively.

[0045] FIG. 5A illustrates an exemplary block diagram of the WL signal source circuit **106W** of FIG. 4, in accordance with various embodiments. In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 5A, the WL signal source circuit **106W** includes a voltage converter **502** (e.g., a charge pump), a transistor **504** (e.g., a p-type MOSFET), a comparator **506** (e.g., an amplifier), a first transmission gate **508**, and a second transmission gate **510**. In some embodiments, the comparator **506** has two input terminals and an output terminal wherein one of the input terminals (e.g., an inverting input terminal) is configured to receive a first reference voltage **511**. The output terminal of the comparator **506** is coupled to a gate of the transistor **504**, and the transistor **504** includes a source coupled to a second reference voltage **513** (e.g., an input/output Vdd) and a drain coupled to the other of the input terminals (e.g., a non-inverting input terminal) of the comparator **506** and the first transmission gate **508**. In some embodiments, the comparator **506** and the transistor **504** form a low-dropout (LDO) regulator that is configured to provide a voltage signal **515** whose signal level is substantially close to the second reference voltage **513**.

[0046] Referring still to FIG. 5A, in some embodiments, the first transmission gate **508** is configured to provide the WL voltage signal **423** based on the voltage signal **515**, which is substantially close to the second reference voltage **513**. In some other embodiments, the charge pump **502** is configured to provide the WL voltage signal **423** through the second transmission gate **510** when a desired signal level of the WL voltage signal **423** is higher than the second reference voltage **513**. In some embodiments, when the desired signal level of the WL voltage signal **423** is not greater than the second reference voltage **513**, the WL voltage signal **423** is provided by the LDO regulator, formed by the comparator **506** and the transistor **504**, through the first transmission gate **508** such that the WL voltage signal **423**'s signal level may be equal to the second reference voltage **513**.

[0047] FIG. 5B illustrates an exemplary block diagram of the BL signal source circuit **106B** of FIG. 4, in accordance with various embodiments. In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 5B, the BL signal source circuit **106B** includes a voltage converter **522** (e.g., a charge pump), a transistor **524** (e.g., a p-type MOSFET), a comparator **526** (e.g., an amplifier), a first transmission gate **528**, and a second transmission gate **530**. In some embodiments, the comparator **526** has two input terminals and an output terminal wherein one of the input terminals (e.g., an inverting input terminal) is configured to receive a first reference voltage **523**. The output terminal of the comparator **526** is coupled to a gate of the transistor **524**, and the transistor **524** includes a source coupled to a second reference voltage **527** (e.g., an input/output Vdd) and a drain coupled to the other of the input terminals (e.g., a non-inverting input terminal) of the comparator **526** and the first transmission gate **528**. Similar as the transistor **504** and comparator **506** of the WL signal source circuit **106W** as shown in FIG. 5A, the comparator **526** and the transistor **524** form another low-dropout (LDO) regulator that is configured to provide a voltage signal **525** whose signal level is substantially close to the second reference voltage **527**.

[0048] Referring still to FIG. 5B, in some embodiments, the first transmission gate **528** is configured to provide the BL voltage signal **453** based on the voltage signal **525**, which is substantially close to the second reference voltage **527**. In some other embodiments, the charge pump **522** is configured to provide the BL voltage signal **453** through the second transmission gate **530** when a desired signal level of the BL voltage signal **453** is higher than the second reference voltage **527**. In some embodiments, when the desired signal level of the BL voltage signal **453** is not greater than the second reference voltage **527**, the BL voltage signal **453** is provided by the LDO regulator, formed by the comparator **526** and the transistor **524**, through the first transmission gate **528** such that the BL voltage signal **453**'s signal level may be equal to the second reference voltage **527**. In some embodiments, the signal level of the WL voltage signal **423** may correspond

to the signal level of the BL voltage signal **453**. For example, the respective signal levels of the WL voltage signals **423** may be different when the BL voltage signal **453** are equal to the set and reset voltages, respectively.

[0049] FIG. **5C** illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of the SA **458** of FIG. **4**, in accordance with various embodiments. As shown in the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **5C**, the SA **458** is also coupled to two RRAM cells **540** and **542** via a portion of the I/O circuit **218** (FIG. **4**), herein referred to as “read circuit **544R**,” and a bias generator circuit **548B**. In some embodiments, the RRAM cells **540** and **542** represent the respective “being-read” RRAM cells of two different ones of the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** that are disposed on opposite sides of the I/O circuit **218** such as, for example, RRAM cells **402** and **406**, RRAM cells **404** and **406**, etc. Accordingly, each of the RRAM cells **540** and **542** is formed by a resistor and a serially coupled transistor, according to some embodiments. For example, the RRAM cell **540** is formed by resistor **540R** and transistor **540T**; and the RRAM cell **542** is formed by resistor **542R** and transistor **542T**.

[0050] In some embodiments, the SA **458** includes a first inverter **544**, a second inverter **546**, a first transmission gate **548**, a second transmission gate **550**, transistors **552**, **554**, **556**, and **558**. The first and second inverters **544** and **546** are cross-coupled to form a latch (i.e., the first inverter **544**'s input terminal coupled to the second inverter **546**'s output terminal, and the second inverter **546**'s input terminal coupled to the first inverter **544**'s output terminal); the first transmission gate **548** is coupled between the first inverter **544**'s input terminal/second inverter **546**'s output terminal and node X; the second transmission gate **550** is coupled between the first inverter **544**'s output terminal/second inverter **546**'s input terminal and node Y; the transistor **552** (e.g., a p-type MOSFET) is coupled between a reference voltage **555** (e.g., Vdd) and the node X; and the transistor **554** (e.g., a p-type MOSFET) is coupled between the reference voltage **555** and the node Y. In some embodiments, the first and second inverters **544** and **546**, the first and second transmission gates **548** and **550**, and the transistors **552** and **554** are configured to perform a sensing/amplifying function so as to determine (e.g., read) logic states of the RRAM cells **540** and **542**, which will be discussed below. The transistors **556** and **558** are respectively coupled to the nodes X and Y, and both coupled to the read circuit **544R** and the bias generator circuit **548B** so as to control a read voltage for the RRAM cells **540** and **542**, which will be discussed below.

[0051] In some embodiments, the read circuit **544R** includes transistors **560**, **562**, **564**, and **566**, transmission gates **568** and **570**, and a reference current source **572**. The transistors **560**, **562**, **564**, and **566** may be each implemented as an n-type MOSFET, or any of various other types of transistors while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure. The RRAM cell **540** is coupled to the SA **458** through the transistor **560** and the transmission gate **568**; and the RRAM cell **542** is coupled to the SA **458** through the transistor **562** and the transmission gate **570**. In some embodiments, when the RRAM cells **540** and **542** represent the RRAM cells **402** (or **404**) and **406** (FIG. **4**), respectively, the transistors **560** and **562** may represent the transistors **438** and **440** (FIG. **4**), respectively, and the transmission gates **568** and **570** may represent the transmission gates **450** and **454** (FIG. **4**), respectively. The read circuit **544R** will be discussed in further detail below when operations of the RRAM architecture **100** are discussed.

[0052] In some embodiments, the bias generator circuit **548B** includes a comparator **573**, transistors **574**, **576**, and **578**, and a variable resistor **580**. The transistor **574** is implemented as a p-type MOSFET, and the transistors **576** and **578** are each implemented as an n-type MOSFET. It is understood that the transistors **574** to **578** can be implemented as any of various other types of transistors while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure. The comparator **573** has two input terminals and an output terminal wherein one of the input terminals (e.g., a non-inverting input terminal) is configured to receive a read voltage **581**. The output terminal of the comparator **573** is coupled to a gate of the transistors **576**, and respective gates of the transistors **556** and **558** of the SA **458**. The transistor **576** includes a source coupled to the other of the input terminals (e.g., an inverting input terminal) of the comparator **573** and a drain of the transistor **578**, and a drain

coupled to the reference voltage 555 through the transistor 574. The transistor 578 is coupled to ground through the variable resistor 580, which can be a poly resistor in some embodiments. Further, in some embodiments, the bias generator circuit 548B is configured to provide a voltage signal 583 based on the read voltage 581. The voltage signal 583 is coupled to gates of the transistors 556 and 558. Such a voltage signal 583, controlled at the read voltage 581, can be used by the RRAM cells 540 and/or 542 for respective read operations.

[0053] Since FIGS. 4-5C respectively illustrate at least a portion of the RRAM architecture 100, to illustrate the operation of the RRAM architecture 100, reference numerals shown in FIGS. 4-5C are again used in the following discussions. In some embodiments, the RRAM architecture 100 can be used for multiple applications with respective different endurance when different RRAM cell arrays in the RRAM macro 108 have different RRAM element sizes and/or different operating voltage levels. For high-endurance applications, an information bit may be written to at least two RRAM cells of the RRAM arrays, disposed at opposite sides of the I/O circuit 218, at its original and complementary logic states, respectively; and for low-endurance applications, an information bit may be written to the RRAM cell of one of the RRAM arrays, disposed at either side of the I/O circuit 218, at its original logic state. Operations of the RRAM architecture 100 to be used for the high-endurance and low-endurance applications will be respectively discussed below.

[0054] In some embodiments, to operate the RRAM architecture 100 for the high-endurance applications, the control logic circuit 104 may first select a pair of RRAM cell arrays (e.g., 204 and 206). In some embodiments, the pair of RRAM cell arrays 204 and 206 are disposed on the opposite sides of the I/O circuit 218. Upon determining the RRAM cell arrays 204 and 206 to be used for high-endurance applications, the control logic circuit 104 selects one RRAM cell from the RRAM cell array 204 to be written into an original logic state of an information bit (e.g., RRAM cell 404), and one RRAM cell from the RRAM cell array 206 to be written into a complementary logic state of the information bit (e.g., RRAM cell 406). In other words, one of the RRAM cells 404 and 406 is set (therefor presenting a logic 1), and the other of the RRAM cells 404 and 406 is reset (therefore presenting a logic 0).

[0055] To access the RRAM cell 404, the control logic circuit 104 asserts the RRAM cell 404's respective WL 414 by complementarily turning on/off the transistors 420U and 420D of the WL driver 210 (e.g., turning on the transistor 420U and off the transistor 420D), and BL 408-2 and SL 412-2 by activating the transmission gates 450 and 452 of the I/O circuit 218. Accordingly, the control logic circuit 104 can allow the WL signal source circuit 106W to provide the WL voltage signal 423 to the selected RRAM cell 404 through the asserted WL 414 to activate (turn on) the transistor 404T of the RRAM cell 404. Simultaneously or subsequently, the control logic circuit 104 can allow the BL signal source circuit 106B to provide the BL voltage signal 453 at a signal level of the set voltage to the RRAM cell 404 through the BL 408-2 or SL 412-2 so as to write a logic 1 to the RRAM cell 404. More specifically, during such a write operation, the control logic circuit 104 may turn off the transistors 438 to isolate the SA 458 from accessing the RRAM cell 404, and turn on the transistor 442 (while turning off the transistor 444) to allow the BL voltage signal 453 to be delivered to the RRAM cell 404 via the SL 412-2 or turn on the transistor 444 (while turning off the transistor 442) to allow the BL voltage signal 453 to be delivered to the RRAM cell 404 via the BL 408-2.

[0056] In some embodiments, to access the RRAM cell 406, the control logic circuit 104 asserts the RRAM cell 406's respective WL 416 by complementarily turning on/off the transistors 422U and 422D of the WL driver 212 (e.g., turning on the transistor 422U and off the transistor 422D), and BL 408-3 and SL 412-3 by activating the transmission gates 454 and 456 of the I/O circuit 218. Accordingly, the control logic circuit 104 can allow the WL signal source circuit 106W to provide the WL voltage signal 423 to the selected RRAM cell 406 through the asserted WL 416 to activate (turn on) the transistor 406T of the RRAM cell 406. Simultaneously or subsequently, the control logic circuit 104 can allow the BL signal source circuit 106B to provide the BL voltage signal 453

at a signal level of the reset voltage to the RRAM cell **406** through the BL **408-3** or SL **412-3** so as to write a logic **0** to the RRAM cell **406**. More specifically, during such a write operation, the control logic circuit **104** may turn off the transistors **438** to isolate the SA **458** from accessing the RRAM cell **406**, and turn on the transistor **446** (while turning off the transistor **448**) to allow the BL voltage signal **453** to be delivered to the RRAM cell **406** via the SL **412-3** or turn on the transistor **448** (while turning off the transistor **446**) to allow the BL voltage signal **453** to be delivered to the RRAM cell **406** via the BL **408-3**. It is noted that the write operations performed on the RRAM cells **404** and **406** do not necessarily occur at the same time, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0057] After the RRAM cells **404** and **406** are respectively written into the original logic state (logic **1**) and complementary logic state (logic **0**) of the information bit, the control logic circuit **104** may concurrently read the respective logic states from the RRAM cells **404** and **406**, in accordance with various embodiments. Similar as the write operation described above, the RRAM cells **404** and **406** are allowed to be read by asserting respective WL's **414** and **416** (through complementarily turning on/off the transistors **420U/420D** and **422U/422D**), and BL's **408-2** and **408-3** and SL's **412-2** and **412-3** (through activating the transmission gates **450**, **452**, **454**, and **456**). To read out the logic states present by the RRAM cells **404** and **406**, in some embodiments, the control logic circuit **104** may turn off the transistors **442**, **444**, **446**, and **448** to isolate the BL voltage signal **453** from the RRAM cells **404** and **406**, and turn on the transistors **438** and **440** to allow the SA **458** to access the RRAM cells **404** and **406**.

[0058] Referring again to FIG. 5C, as mentioned above, the two RRAM cells **540** and **542** represent the RRAM cells being read (i.e., the RRAM cell **404** and **406** in the current example), the transistors **560** and **562** respectively represent the being-read RRAM cells' corresponding pass gate transistors **438** and **440** (FIG. 4), and the transmission gates **568** and **570** respectively represent the being-read RRAM cells' corresponding transmission gates **450** and **454** (FIG. 4). In some embodiments, to read the respective logic states from the two RRAM cells **540** (e.g., **404**) and **542** (e.g., **406**) that are disposed in different arrays, the control logic circuit **104** may first turn off the transistors **564** and **566** to isolate the reference current source **572** from the RRAM cells from the RRAM cells **540** and **542**. However, in some embodiments, the control logic circuit **104** may complementarily turn on the transistors **564** and **566** when only one of the RRAM cells **540** and **542** is read, which will be discussed below.

[0059] Referring still to FIG. 5C, in some embodiments, the control logic circuit **104** may turn on the transistor **574** to activate the bias generator circuit **548B**. Upon being activated, an LDO circuit, formed by the comparator **573** and the transistor **576**, is configured to provide the voltage signal **583** with a signal level substantially close to the read voltage **581**. Further, such an LDO circuit may rely on the transistor **578** and the variable resistor **580** that can simulate a loading of the read RRAM cells **540/542** so as to provide a more reliable read voltage to the RRAM cells **540** and **542**. As mentioned above, the transistors **556** and **558** are configured to receive the voltage signal **583** at the read voltage as provided by the bias generator circuit **548B**. In some embodiments, such a read voltage is applied to the RRAM cell **540** (e.g., **404**) via the SL **412-2** and the RRAM cell **542** (e.g., **406**) via the SL **412-3** while the respective BL's **408-2** and **408-3** may be coupled to ground. Since the respective transistors **404T** and **406T** of the RRAM cells **540** (e.g., **404**) and **542** (e.g., **406**) are turned on (i.e., both representing a substantially similar ON resistance), current signals **591** and **593** (FIG. 5C) conducting through the respective resistors **404R** of the RRAM cell **540**, which has been set to the LRS, and **406R** of the RRAM cell **542**, which has been reset to the HRS, may have respective different signal levels. In some embodiments, the current signals **591** and **593** may be concurrently generated to respectively conduct through the RRAM cells **540** and **542**. More specifically, in the current example where the RRAM cells **540** and **542** respectively represent the RRAM cells **404** and **406** (FIG. 4), the current signal **591** may flow through the SL **412-2**, the transistor **404T**, the resistor **404R**, the BL **408-2**, optionally the BL **408-1**, the transistors **428** and

426, and to ground; the current signal **593** may flow through the SL **412-3**, the transistor **406T**, the resistor **406R**, the BL **408-3**, the transistors **432** and **434**, and to ground. In some embodiments, the transistors **426**, **428**, **430**, **432**, **434**, and **436** may be selectively turned on or off by the control logic circuit **104**. In some embodiments, the current signals **591** and **593** are referred to as the information bit's corresponding LRS and HRS current signals, respectively.

[0060] In some embodiments, such two current signals **591** and **593** may change voltage levels at the nodes X and Y until respective voltage levels (i.e., logic states) at the nodes X and Y are latched (i.e., fixed) by the cross-coupled inverters **544** and **546**. In some embodiments, prior to the current signals **591** and **593** changing the voltage levels at the nodes X and Y, the control logic circuit **104** may turn on the transistors **552** and **554** to pre-charge the inverters **544** and **546** through the transmission gates **548** and **550**, which are optional. After the voltage levels (i.e., logic states) at the nodes X and Y are latched (or determined) by the SA **458**, the control logic circuit **104** may accordingly determine the respective logic states present by the RRAM cells **540** (e.g., **404**) and **542** (e.g., **406**). In the current example, the logic states of the RRAM cells **404** and **406** determined by the control logic circuit **104** may be a logic **1** and a logic **0**, respectively.

[0061] The control logic circuit **104** of the disclosed RRAM architecture **100** determines a logic state of an information bit by comparing two different current signals conducting through two RRAM cells that were written to an information bit's original and complementary logic states, respectively. By doing so, the SA **458** can more efficiently determine the original logic state of the information bit. This is because in the existing RRAM device whose RRAM's logic state can only be determined by comparing a current signal conducting therethrough with a pre-defined reference current. And a current level of the pre-defined reference current is typically chosen to be in the middle of current levels of two statistic current signals (one is a statistically determined HRS current signal of the existing RRAM device, and the other is a statistically determined LRS current signal of the existing RRAM device) so as to allow a corresponding SA to correctly determine whether the logic state present by the RRAM cell is a logic **1** or **0**. As such, a current level difference between the reference current and a to-be determined current signal (either a LRS current signal or a HRS current signal) conducting through any RRAM cell is relatively small. In stark contrast, the SA **458** of the disclosed RRAM architecture **100** relies on two different current signals that have been intentionally conducted as one information bit's corresponding HRS and LRS current signals, which can have a substantially greater current level difference therebetween, to determine the original logic state of the information bit. As a result, when writing a pair of RRAM cells to cause them to respectively conduct an information bit's corresponding HRS and LRS current signals, in turn, the voltage levels of the respective set and reset voltages (i.e., the write voltages) can be substantially lower, which allows the RRAM cells to have a higher endurance.

[0062] In some embodiments, operating the RRAM architecture **100** to be used for the low-endurance applications is substantially similar to the high-endurance applications as discussed above except that the control logic circuit **104** may cause an information bit to be written into the RRAM cell(s) of one RRAM cell array (e.g., the RRAM cell **402** of the RRAM cell array **202**) of the RRAM architecture **100** as its original logic state. Since writing the information bit into the RRAM cell **402** as its original logic state is substantially similar to writing the RRAM cell **404**, as discussed above, the discussion is not repeated here. In some embodiments, when reading the logic state written into the RRAM cell **402**, a reference current source may be used. Referring again to FIGS. **4** and **5C** concurrently, when reading the RRAM cell **402** (corresponding to the being-read RRAM cell **540** in FIG. **5C**), the control logic circuit **104** may turn on the transistor **438** (corresponding to the transistor **560** in FIG. **5C**) and turn off the transistor **440** (corresponding to the transistor **562** in FIG. **5C**), and turn on the transistor **566** and turn off the transistor **564**. As such, the SA **458** can compare the current signal **591** conducting through the RRAM cell **540** (e.g., **402**) with the a reference current provided by the reference current source **572** so as to determine (read) the logic state of the information bit written to the RRAM cell **540** (e.g., **402**). As a result,

when writing an RRAM cell to conduct an information bit's corresponding HRS or LRS current signal (depending on the information bit's original logic state), in turn, the RRAM cell may have a lower endurance.

[0063] Based on the above-discussed operations of the RRAM architecture **100**, it is understood that the control logic circuit **104** can be used in multiple applications with respective different endurances by choosing a pair of the RRAM cell arrays (e.g., **204** and **206**) to present respective original and complementary logic states of information bits that are used in high-endurance applications and a single RRAM cell (e.g., e.g., **202**) to present original logic states of information bits that are used in low-endurance applications. Moreover, the RRAM cells of such RRAM cell arrays that are used in different applications can be formed on a same chip (e.g., **102** of FIG. **1**) by a single recipe.

[0064] FIG. **5D** illustrates exemplary operation comparisons between two types of sensing amplifier circuits, in accordance with some embodiments. The first sensing amplifier (SA) circuit **585** utilizes one cell to represent one bit (1c1b); while the second sensing amplifier (SA) circuit **595** utilizes two cells to represent one bit (2c1b).

[0065] For the 1c1b circuit **585**, a logic bit is determined by comparing the target cell current I_{cell_T} with the reference current I_{ref} . Two current distributions corresponding to two logic bits (0 and 1) respectively are shown in the operation plot **586** of the 1c1b circuit **585**. A key parameter to an endurance of the 1c1b circuit **585** is the tail-to-tail window, i.e. the distance between the two tails, i.e. tail currents corresponding to logic **0** (IR_0) and logic **1** (IR_1), of the two distributions in the operation plot **586**. To distinguish between logic bits **0** and **1**, the reference current I_{ref} is put in the middle of the two tail currents of IR_0 and IR_1 . For example, to have an endurance margin of 5 μA , both the distance between I_{ref} and IR_0 and the distance between I_{ref} and IR_1 need to be 5 μA . As such, a 10 μA tail-to-tail window is needed for the 1c1b circuit **585** to achieve an endurance of 5 μA .

[0066] For the 2c1b circuit **595**, a logic bit is determined by comparing the target cell current I_{cell_T} with the complimentary current I_{cell_C} that always represents a complimentary logic bit of that represented by the I_{cell_T} . Two current distributions corresponding to two logic bits (**0** and **1**) respectively are shown in the operation plot **596** of the 2c1b circuit **595**. A key parameter to an endurance of the 2c1b circuit **595** is also the tail-to-tail window, i.e. the distance between the two tails of the two distributions of I_{cell_T} and I_{cell_C} . For example, to have an endurance margin of 5 μA , the distance between tails of I_{cell_T} and I_{cell_C} may be 5 μA (or even a smaller distance because it is very unlikely for both I_{cell_T} and I_{cell_C} to fall into the worst case at the two tails at the same time). As such, only a 5 μA tail-to-tail window is needed for the 2c1b circuit **595** to achieve an endurance of 5 μA .

[0067] That is, to achieve a same endurance, the 2c1b circuit **595** needs a smaller tail-to-tail window than the 1c1b circuit **585**. Alternatively, by having a same tail-to-tail window, the 2c1b circuit **595** will have a higher endurance than the 1c1b circuit **585**. As discussed above, a same recipe may be used to manufacture these two types of SA circuits in a same RRAM macro, to save cost and satisfy different endurance applications at the same time. The two types of SA circuits generated by the same recipe will have same thickness and crystalline structure, but different diameters and endurance levels.

[0068] FIG. **6** illustrates a flow chart of an exemplary method **600** to operate the RRAM architecture **100**, in accordance with various embodiments. In various embodiments, the operations of the method **600** are performed by the respective components illustrated in FIGS. **1-5C**. For purposes of discussion, the following embodiment of the method **600** will be described in conjunction with FIGS. **1-5C**. The illustrated embodiment of the method **600** is merely an example. Therefore, it should be understood that any of a variety of operations may be omitted, re-sequenced, and/or added while remaining within the scope of the present disclosure.

[0069] The method **600** starts with operation **602** in which an RRAM architecture including a

plurality of RRAM cell arrays that share a universal variable resistance dielectric layer is provided. In some embodiments, the plurality of RRAM cell arrays may share a same I/O circuit but each of the RRAM cell arrays corresponds to a respective WL driver. In one example, such an RRAM architecture may include the RRAM architecture **100**. As discussed with reference to FIGS. **1** and **2**, the RRAM architecture **100** includes an RRAM macro **108** with at least three RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, and **206** disposed on the single chip **102**, and the RRAM cells in each of the RRAM cell arrays include an universal variable resistance dielectric layer (e.g., **332** with references to FIG. **3**) that is formed by a single recipe.

[0070] The method **600** continues to operation **604** in which first and second RRAM cell arrays are selected to be used in a first application. Next, the method **600** continues to operation **606** in which a third RRAM cell array is selected to be used in a second application. In some embodiments, such first and second applications require respective different endurances, for example, the first application may require a higher endurance (e.g., data storage) and the second application may require a lower endurance (e.g., eFuse). In some embodiments, such selection may be performed by the control logic circuit **104**. In some embodiments, the first and second RRAM cell arrays are disposed at opposite sides of the shared I/O circuit **218**.

[0071] The method **600** continues to operation **608** in which a first information bit's original logic state and complementary logic state are written to respective RRAM cells of the first and second RRAM cell arrays. In some embodiments, the first information bit represents a portion of data used in the first application that requires the higher endurance. In some embodiments, the RRAM cell of the first RRAM cell array is written into the information bit's original logic state, and the RRAM cell of the second RRAM cell array is written into the information bit's complementary logic state.

[0072] Next, the method **600** continues to operation **610** in which a second information bit's original logic state is written to an RRAM cell of the third RRAM cell array. In some embodiments, the second information bit represents a portion of data used in the second application that requires the lower endurance. In some embodiments, the RRAM cell of the third RRAM cell array is written into the information bit's original logic state.

[0073] The method **600** continues to operation **612** in which the first information bit's original logic state is determined based on current signals conducting through the respective RRAM cells of the first and second RRAM cell arrays. In some embodiments, since the first information bit's original and complementary logic states are respectively written to the RRAM cells of the first and second RRAM cell arrays, the current signals may correspond to the first information bit's corresponding HRS (high resistance state) and LRS (low resistance state) current signals. In some embodiments, the original and complementary logic states of the first information bit may be determined by the SA **458** of the shared I/O circuit **218**. The method **600** continues to operation **614** in which the second information bit's original logic state is determined based on a current signal conducting through the RRAM cell of the third RRAM cell array. In some embodiments, since the second information bit's original logic state is written to the RRAM cell of the third RRAM cell array, the current signal may correspond to the second information bit's corresponding HRS (high resistance state) or LRS (low resistance state) current signal (based on the second information's original logic state). In some embodiments, the original state of the second information bit may be determined by the SA **458** of the shared I/O circuit **218**.

[0074] FIG. **7** illustrates a flow chart of an exemplary method **700** to fabricate the RRAM macro **108** of FIG. **2**, in accordance with some embodiments. As discussed above, the RRAM macro **108** includes different RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, **206**. Each of the RRAM cell arrays **202**, **204**, **206** may include a resistor between a source line and a bit line. The resistor may be formed as a multi-layer stack that includes a top electrode, a capping node, a resistance dielectric, and a bottom electrode.

[0075] As shown in FIG. **7**, a source line layer is formed at operation **710**. At operation **720**, a bottom electrode layer including a plurality of bottom electrodes is formed on the source line layer.

Each of the plurality of bottom electrodes is formed for a different RRAM cell. The bottom electrodes are formed using a same single recipe but different layout sizes for different cell arrays. As such, bottom electrodes in different cell arrays **202, 204, 206** can have same thickness and crystalline structure, but different diameters. At operation **730**, a variable resistance dielectric layer including a plurality of resistance dielectrics is formed on the bottom electrode layer. Each of the plurality of resistance dielectrics is formed for a different RRAM cell. The resistance dielectrics are formed using a same single recipe but different layout sizes for different cell arrays. As such, resistance dielectrics in different cell arrays **202, 204, 206** can have same thickness and crystalline structure, but different diameters. At operation **740**, a capping layer including a plurality of capping nodes is formed on the variable resistance dielectric layer. Each of the plurality of capping nodes is formed for a different RRAM cell. The capping nodes are formed using a same single recipe but different layout sizes for different cell arrays. As such, capping nodes in different cell arrays **202, 204, 206** can have same thickness and crystalline structure, but different diameters. At operation **750**, a top electrode layer including a plurality of top electrodes on the capping layer. Each of the plurality of top electrodes is formed for a different RRAM cell. The top electrodes are formed using a same single recipe but different layout sizes for different cell arrays. As such, top electrodes in different cell arrays **202, 204, 206** can have same thickness and crystalline structure, but different diameters. A bit line layer is formed on the top electrode layer at operation **760**.

[0076] An aspect of the present disclosure relates to a memory device. The memory device includes a first cell array may include a first plurality of bit cells configured for transitioning between logic states. The device also includes a second cell array may include a second plurality of bit cells configured for transitioning between logic states. The device also includes a control logic circuit configured to cause a first information bit to be written into a first bit cell in the first cell array as an original logic state of the first information bit, and to cause a second information bit to be written into a second bit cell in the second cell array as an original logic state of the second information bit. The device also includes a third cell array may include a third plurality of bit cells, where the control logic circuit is further configured to cause a logically complementary state of the first information bit to be stored in a third bit cell in the third cell array.

[0077] Another aspect of the present disclosure relates to a memory device. The memory device includes a first cell array may include a first plurality of bit cells; a second cell array may include a second plurality of bit cells; a third cell array may include a third plurality of bit cells; a control logic circuit configured to cause a first information bit to be written into a first bit cell of the first cell array as an original logic state of the first information bit, cause a logically complementary state of the first information bit to be stored in a third bit cell of the third cell array, and cause a second information bit to be written into a second bit cell of the second cell array as an original logic state of the second information bit; and a sensing circuit, coupled to the first plurality of bit cells, the second plurality of bit cells, and the third plurality of bit cells, and configured to determine the original logic state present in the first information bit by comparing a first current signal conducting through the first bit cell in the first cell array with a third current signal conducting through the third bit cell in the third cell array.

[0078] Another aspect of the present disclosure relates to a method. The method includes causing a first information bit to be written into a first bit cell in a first plurality of bit cells as an original logic state of the first information bit. The method also includes causing a second information bit to be written into a second bit cell in a second plurality of bit cells as an original logic state of the second information bit. The method also includes causing a third information bit to be written into a third bit cell in a third plurality of bit cells as a logically complementary state of the first information bit.

[0079] The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those ordinary skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying

other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A memory device, comprising: a first cell array comprising a first plurality of bit cells configured for transitioning between logic states; a second cell array comprising a second plurality of bit cells configured for transitioning between logic states; a control logic circuit configured to cause a first information bit to be written into a first bit cell in the first cell array as an original logic state of the first information bit, and to cause a second information bit to be written into a second bit cell in the second cell array as an original logic state of the second information bit; and a third cell array comprising a third plurality of bit cells, wherein the control logic circuit is further configured to cause a logically complementary state of the first information bit to be stored in a third bit cell in the third cell array.
2. The memory device of claim 1, wherein: each of the first plurality of bit cells comprises a first variable resistance dielectric layer for transitioning between logic states, each of the second plurality of bit cells comprises a second variable resistance dielectric layer for transitioning between logic states, and the first and second variable resistance dielectric layers have a substantially identical thickness and/or crystalline structure.
3. The memory device of claim 2, wherein: the first variable resistance dielectric layer has a first diameter, the second variable resistance dielectric layer has a second diameter, and the first diameter is smaller than the second diameter.
4. The memory device of claim 1, further comprising: a sensing circuit, coupled to the first, second and third cell arrays, and configured to determine the original logic state present in the first information bit by comparing a first current signal conducting through the first bit cell in the first cell array with a third current signal conducting through the third bit cell in the third cell array.
5. The memory device of claim 4, wherein the sensing circuit is further configured to determine the original logic state present in the second information bit by comparing a second current signal conducting through the second bit cell in the second cell array with a reference current signal.
6. The memory device of claim 1, wherein: each of the first, the second, and the third cell arrays comprises a resistive random access memory (RRAM) bit cell.
7. A memory device, comprising: a first cell array comprising a first plurality of bit cells; a second cell array comprising a second plurality of bit cells; a third cell array comprising a third plurality of bit cells; a control logic circuit configured to cause a first information bit to be written into a first bit cell of the first cell array as an original logic state of the first information bit, cause a logically complementary state of the first information bit to be stored in a third bit cell of the third cell array, and cause a second information bit to be written into a second bit cell of the second cell array as an original logic state of the second information bit; and a sensing circuit, coupled to the first plurality of bit cells, the second plurality of bit cells, and the third plurality of bit cells, and configured to determine the original logic state present in the first information bit by comparing a first current signal conducting through the first bit cell in the first cell array with a third current signal conducting through the third bit cell in the third cell array.
8. The memory device of claim 7, wherein the sensing circuit is further configured to read out the original logic state present in the second information bit by comparing a second current signal conducting through the second bit cell in the second cell array with a reference current signal.
9. The memory device of claim 7, wherein: a first endurance of a first bit cell of the first cell array comprises a maximum number of cycles for which the first bit cell is operative to transit between

respective different resistance states; and a second endurance of a second bit cell of the second cell array comprises a maximum number of cycles for which the second bit cell is configured to transit between different resistance states.

10. The memory device of claim 9, wherein the first endurance is substantially higher than the second endurance.

11. The memory device of claim 9, wherein: the first plurality of bit cells uses a first variable resistance dielectric layer to transition between logic states, the second plurality of bit cells uses a second variable resistance dielectric layer to transit between logic states, and the first variable resistance dielectric layer has a first diameter, the second variable resistance dielectric layer has a second diameter different from the first diameter.

12. The memory device of claim 11, wherein: each bit cell in the third plurality of bit cells is operative to be transited between logic states based on a third variable resistance dielectric layer, and the third variable resistance dielectric layer has the first diameter.

13. The memory device of claim 7, wherein the first and third cell arrays are disposed at respective opposite sides of the sensing circuit.

14. The memory device of claim 7, wherein each bit cell in the first plurality of bit cells, the second plurality of bit cells, and the third plurality of bit cells, comprises a resistive random access memory (RRAM) bit cell.

15. The memory device of claim 7, wherein: the first, second, and third cell arrays are formed as a memory macro disposed on a single chip; and the first bit cell and the second bit cell have different diameters.

16. A method, comprising: causing a first information bit to be written into a first bit cell in a first plurality of bit cells as an original logic state of the first information bit; causing a second information bit to be written into a second bit cell in a second plurality of bit cells as an original logic state of the second information bit; and causing a third information bit to be written into a third bit cell in a third plurality of bit cells as a logically complementary state of the first information bit.

17. The method of claim 16, causing the first plurality of bit cells using a first variable resistance dielectric layer to transition between logic states; causing the second plurality of bit cells to transit between logic states based on a second variable resistance dielectric layer; and wherein: the first variable resistance dielectric layer has a first diameter; the second variable resistance dielectric layer has a second diameter; and the first diameter is smaller than the second diameter.

18. The method of claim 16, further comprising: determining the original logic state present in the first information bit by comparing a first current signal conducting through the first bit cell in the first plurality of bit cells with a third current signal conducting through the third bit cell in the third plurality of bit cells.

19. The method of claim 16, further comprising: determining the original logic state present in the second information bit by comparing a second current signal conducting through the second bit cell in the second plurality of bit cells with a reference current signal.

20. The method of claim 16, wherein: the first plurality of bit cells forms a first cell array; the second plurality of bit cells forms a second cell array; the third plurality of bit cells forms a third cell array; and the first and third cell arrays are disposed at respective opposite sides of a sensing circuit.
